

BEST PRACTICE
SERIES

Google + Facebook

A Playbook for Cross-Channel Success



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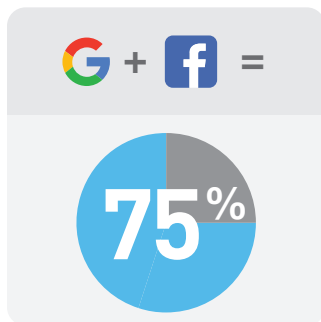
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1. Introduction

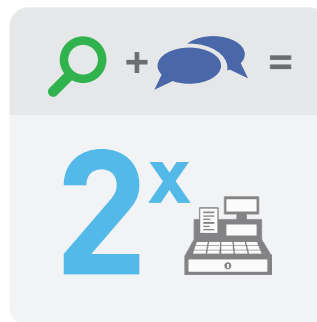
A Golden Opportunity

It's no secret that Google and Facebook rule the digital marketing space, dominating both consumer moments and overall ad spend. In the US alone, these online behemoths accounted for **99% of revenue growth** from digital advertising in 2016.¹ Facebook and Google represent the engine of advertising growth, where digital ad spend surpassed TV for the first time in April 2017, according to the Internet Bureau of Advertising (IAB).²



People spend 75% of their time on either Facebook or Google.³

Advertisers who coordinate campaigns between platforms significantly increase the likelihood of more clicks, conversions, and revenue.



Customers who click your search and social ads are more likely to buy.

Users who click an advertiser's search and social ads have a 2x greater conversion rate than users who click the search ad only. The impact of a cross-channel touch is even greater with social clicks. Users who click both a search and social ad have a click-through rate approximately four and a half times higher than users who only click social ads.⁴



Customers who click your search and social ads spend more.

Users who click both a search and social ad contribute approximately two times more revenue per click than users who click search ads only. Multi-channel touchpoints are even more valuable for social advertising. Users who click both a search and social ad contribute six times more revenue per click than users who click a social ad only.²²

¹ Alex Heath, Facebook and Google completely dominate the digital ad industry, Business Insider, April 26, 2017.

² Danny Fratella, Digital ad revenue surpasses TV for the first time, says IAB, Social Blade, May 1, 2017.

³ Parse.ly analysis.

⁴ Marin Software, The Multiplier Effect of Integrating Search and Social Advertising.

But don't let these dizzying cross-channel results distract you—it's still really important to identify each channel's unique strengths. This playbook will delve into detail about each channel's respective strengths and differences, to help you understand how they can work best with your campaigns.

Drawing insights from Marin Software's customer base, this playbook will show that marketers can achieve top performance with aligned messaging, campaign objectives, and data across both Facebook and Google. Techniques like sequential storytelling are standard in social ads, but the search intent from Google offers an important added touchpoint. It's clear that having a cross-channel view of performance is the best way to measure success and refine your campaigns with continual improvements over time.

The Disadvantages of a Divided Approach

We know that change is difficult, particularly when you're adjusting established campaigns that have delivered successful outcomes in the past. However, if you're tempted to adopt a "wait-and-see" approach to cross-channel advertising, consider that your search and social advertising teams may be working against each other in multiple ways, including:

- Delivery of mixed messages (customers seeing prospect-oriented messages, for example)
- Overexposure of a message on both channels, often simultaneously
- Uncertainty over which channel drove conversion due to lack of attribution
- Inability to continue customer conversations across both channels
- Misallocated budget based on double counting conversions and making decisions on a partial view of the true customer journey

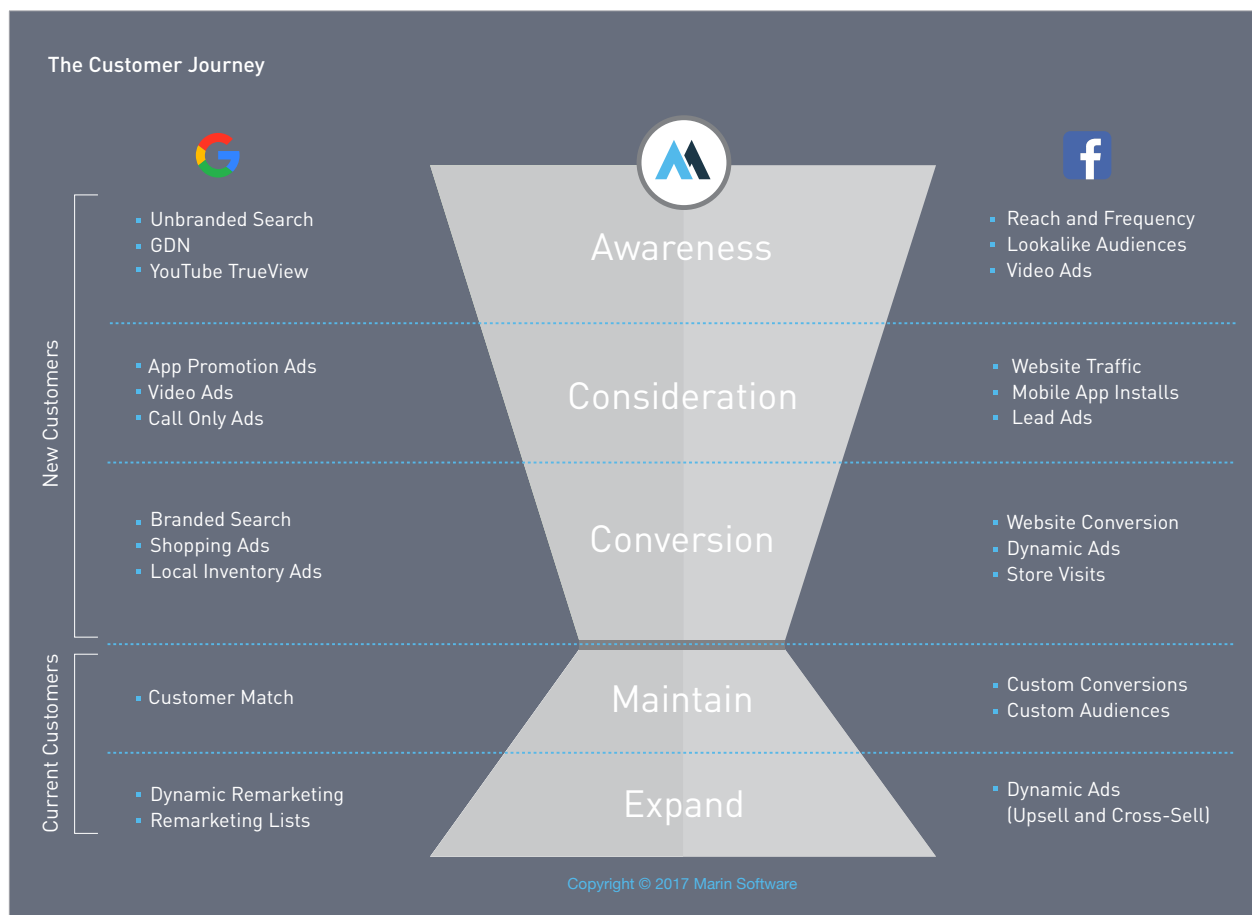
As digital marketing matures, Marin Software has begun advising customers to unify search and social. This strategic shift is no longer a forward-thinking luxury—it's now a necessity for businesses to maximize their ad spend cross-channel. This playbook provides clear guidance on how to implement a cross-channel campaign on Google and Facebook to achieve incremental revenue growth. We'll stress the importance of looking at your digital channels from a holistic lens, with actionable plays for optimizing the entire customer journey.

Connecting Channels with Marin

The benefits of a combined search and social strategy are substantial and the mandate is clear—marketers who unify their programs and focus on the journey, not the channel, deliver incremental ROI.

Long gone are the days of Facebook being considered a pure top of the funnel play and Google predominantly a bottom of the funnel performance driver. Marin has created a graphic to illustrate how Google and Facebook ads parallel one another across the customer journey, within each stage of the funnel.

Both channels now have very specific ad formats to target both new and existing customers along the path to conversion. This playbook provides a closer look at each channel's offering, highlighting similarities, differences, and use cases to help you better formulate digital marketing strategies with a cross-channel view.



Cross-Channel Advertising: A Real-World Example

As savvy marketers know, it often takes multiple touches with a brand before a prospect or existing customer takes a desired action. We've created a sample workflow that illustrates how Google and Facebook can work together in an integrated, cross-channel way to deliver both new conversions and repeat purchases.



As we follow Amy through the customer journey, it's notable that the Facebook video ad she viewed was based on the search intent from Google. Leveraging that search intent cross-channel, Marin was able to serve Amy with a relevant video ad for the particular hotel ad that she viewed. In other words, had Amy not clicked the search ad on Google, she would have never seen the Facebook ad.

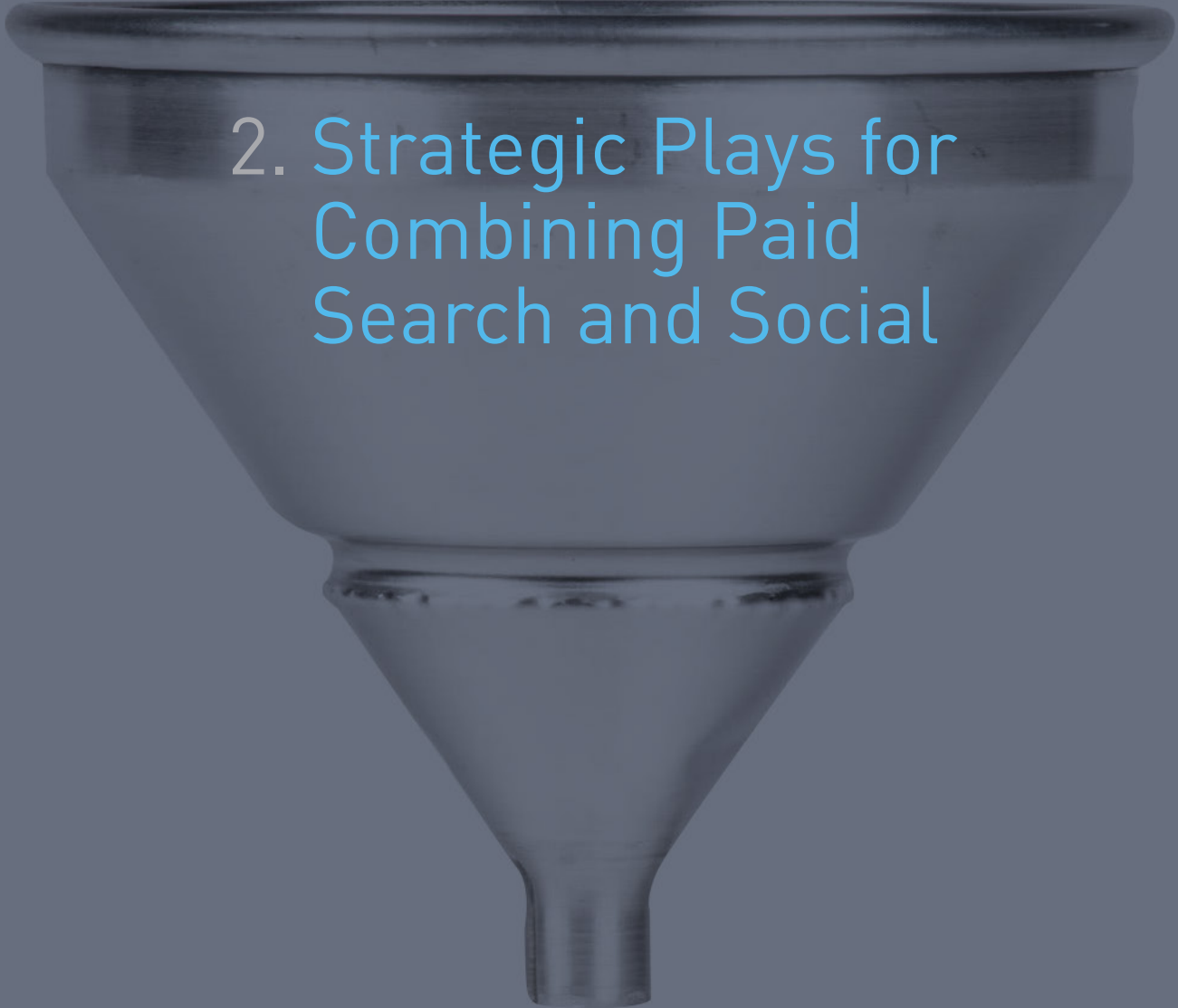
This purchase is a great example of how dynamically generated micro audience segments on Facebook can deliver incremental returns from a conversion that never would have occurred had it not started with the first Google click. In a nutshell, that explains the true potential of cross-channel advertising to span the entire customer journey and drive meaningful conversions.

Unified Attribution Versus Last-Click

As digital advertising evolves, many advertisers seek a more sophisticated solution than last-click attribution to track conversions. In a cross-channel world, where users see ads in different formats and often on multiple devices, it's important to identify all the sources that influence a conversion rather than just one final conversion event. The table below shows how a last-click attribution model compares to unified attribution in the context of a cross-channel customer journey on Facebook and Google. Instead of attributing the entire conversion to Google's last click, you can see how a using unified attribution values all touch points in the actual user's journey.

Channel	Campaign	Ad Format	Date	Keyword	Audience	Google Click (Last Click)	Facebook View (Last Click)	Unified View
	- Prospects - Hawaii - Hotels	Text Ad	01/12/2017	- Top - Hotels - Hawaii - Pool - Bar	Exclusion Audience: Customers	0	0	.33
	- Prospects - Hawaii - Hotels - Search - Intent	Video Ad	01/20/2017	NA	Search Intent Hotel Seekers	0	0	.33
	- Prospects - Brand - Terms	Hotel Ads	02/04/2017	"[Brand Name] Hawaii"	Exclusion Audience: Customers	1	0	.33
	- Customers - Hawaii - Hotels	Dynamic Ads for Travel	03/12/2017	NA	Cross-Sell: Dynamic Ads for Travel	0	1	.50

Here, with unified attribution, each touchpoint receives credit for the path to conversion. The total value of a conversion is one—a last-click attribution model wouldn't give any credit to the video ad highlighting the hotel brand, which ultimately led to Amy searching on Google two weeks later and converting.



2. Strategic Plays for Combining Paid Search and Social

Digital advertisers typically have a primary goal: growth. Marin software has identified 10 ways to coordinate Facebook and Google campaigns that deliver growth while improving campaign efficiency and saving time, based on our experience running cross-channel programs with our customers.

Planning

1. Coordinate your story across channels.

It's important to develop a narrative that includes consistent messaging across Google and Facebook. For example, if you're running a direct response initiative to drive e-commerce sales, make sure the call to action in your Google text ads mirrors messaging in your Facebook prospecting ads. How would you react if you saw these messages sequentially in both channels—is it clear what action the user is being asked to take?

2. Align objectives and formats across channels.

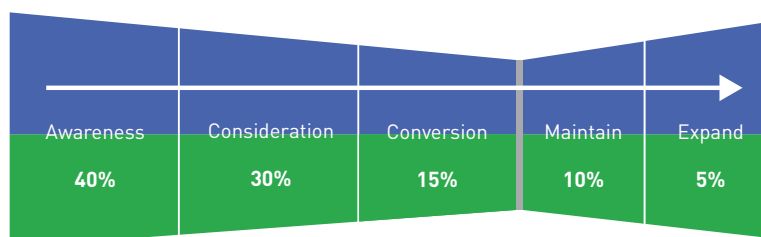
Marin recommends that you include ad formats across both channels that reinforce your objectives. For example, if you're a direct response retail advertiser looking to promote a store-only offer, include Google's Local Inventory Ads and Facebook's Store Visits objective into your media plan.

Once you've aligned objectives, be mindful of how various formats can work together across each stage of the buyer journey. Here are a few reliable options:

- Mirror the sitelink extensions on Google to your key messages on Facebook.
- Drive a lift in traffic and conversion volume of brand terms on Google by prospecting net new customers with video ads on Facebook.
- Ensure keyword coverage on Google based on potential queries from people who watched the video on Facebook (these include hashtags, actors, and branded terms).
- Retarget non-converters from AdWords campaigns with Lead Ads or Dynamic Ads on Facebook.
- Cross-sell recent AdWords converters on Facebook. Tip: We recommend targeting people within one week of conversion.
- Use Marin Search Intent audiences on Facebook to retarget or cross-sell potential customers.

3. Allocate budget between new and existing customers.

Consider using Google's Customer Match and Facebook's Custom Audiences to differentiate messaging between customers and prospects. It's always a good idea to exclude customers from all of your prospect-oriented campaigns with monthly refreshes. We'll discuss how to use naming conventions to roll up performance in the Measurement section of this playbook.



4. Run a test.

Still skeptical about the impact of incremental spend in either channel? We suggest that you run a test and let your data tell the story. This approach can be helpful when working across siloed organizations and tests are not difficult to implement—both Google and Facebook have solutions to measure the incremental lift impact from ad spend.

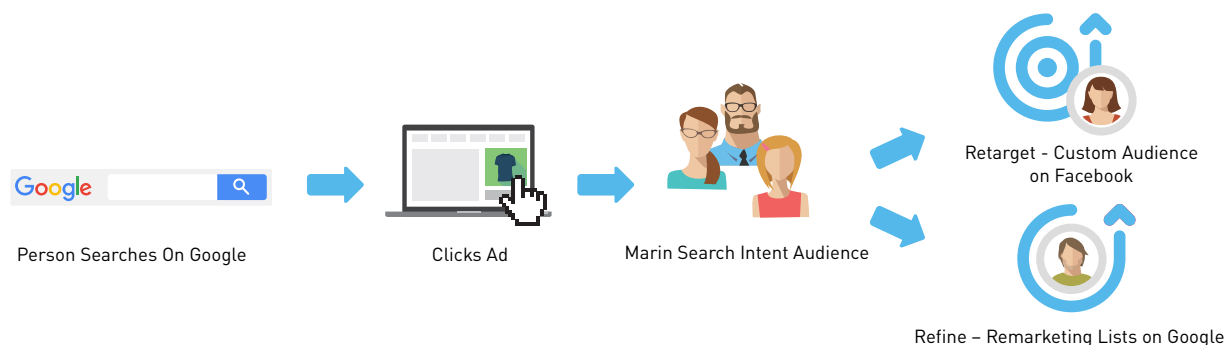
With Facebook's Conversion Lift tool, you can generate a randomized test group of people that see ads and a control group of people that don't. Google's model comparison tool lets you determine performance lift derived from specific AdWords campaigns or across all programs. You can run randomized experiments from web traffic and apply an attribution model to understand which channel gets credit for conversion activity.

Execution

5. Use search intent data to optimize campaigns on both Google and Facebook.

People are telling Google exactly what they're looking for when they use search queries. With a cross-channel strategy, you can leverage this information to tailor the ads people see on Facebook by creating audiences based on their search terms. We've included some examples from Marin's platform that show how search intent can influence your Facebook ads:

- A user searches for a brand term. Change the messaging in your Facebook campaigns to focus on that user's clearly expressed brand affinity.
- Non-branded queries related to your offering can be converted into highly relevant ads across the Facebook universe. For example, if people are searching on Google for San Francisco hotels with a specific amenity (such as ocean views or walking distance to downtown), it's possible to highlight that desired amenity in your Facebook ad copy.
- Leverage the Lookalike Audiences feature, which aligns with Google search queries to enable targeted prospecting on Facebook.



6. Leverage social engagement data on Facebook to inform your paid search strategies.

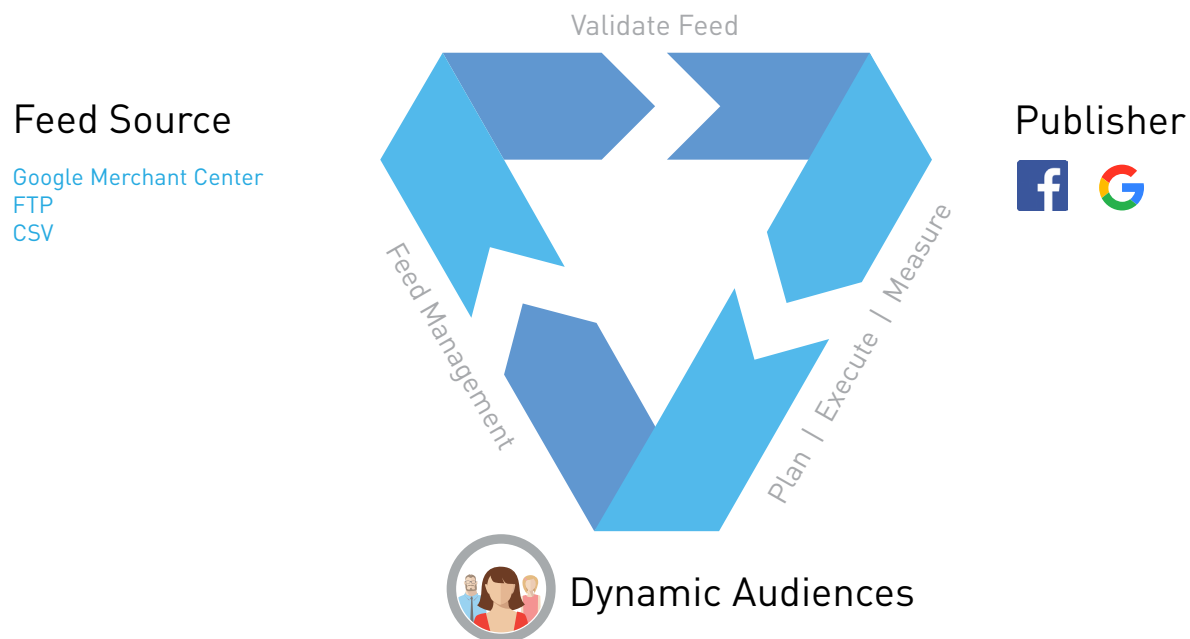
Facebook's Audience Insights tool lets you perform analysis of your customer base to generate insights like age, gender, likes, purchase behavior, and interests. A cross-channel strategy will help you to use these insights to craft your copywriting strategy for highly effective Google search campaigns.

Use top-of-funnel strategies on Facebook—like driving awareness with a video ad that references specific keywords—to increase paid search volume and conversions.

Create audience segments on Google based on engagement insights from Facebook to achieve more precise bidding and targeting. For example, if women converted at a significantly higher rate than men on a Facebook campaign for a particular product, you can use this insight to add female demographic targeting to your Google ad groups and bid higher in these groups.

7. Coordinate Dynamic Ads.

Many Marin Software customers have chosen to align account structures across Facebook Dynamic Ads and Google Shopping to coordinate cross-channel messaging and optimization. Keep in mind that Facebook product sets need to have enough items to ensure delivery. You can create a cross-sell product set of high-margin products on Facebook—for example, men's smart fitness watches—to cross-sell audiences who purchase fitness apparel on Google. Similarly, you can create a Google product group for all men's fitness products with a campaign or ad set of top performers. Increase budget and bids to drive bottom of the funnel conversion on Google—then, increase overall lifetime value (LTV) with cross-sell campaigns of smart fitness watches by running Facebook Dynamic Ads to reach the increased audience volume driven from search.



8. Cross-channel cross-sell.

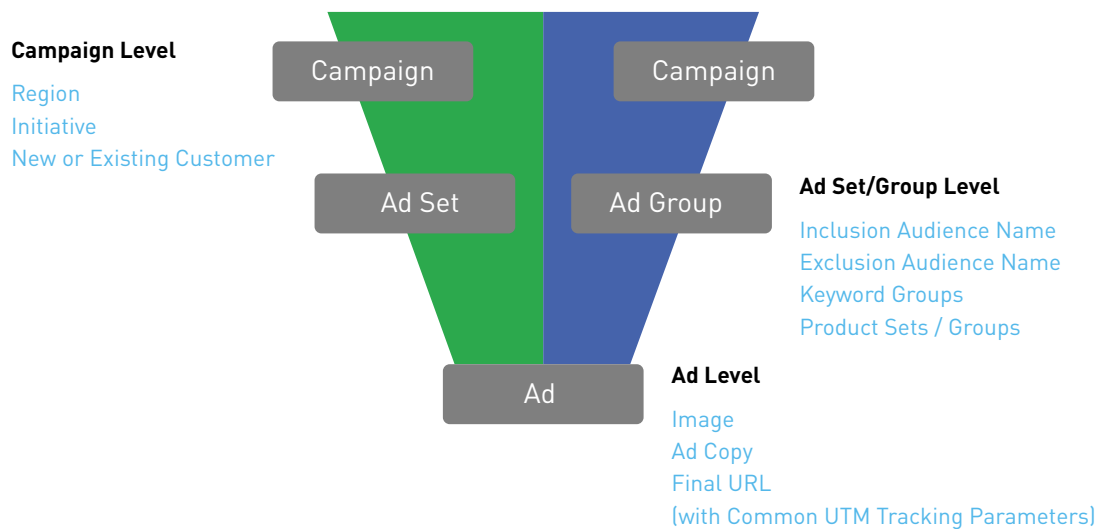
Here's a simple cross-channel play that we can recommend to all digital advertisers—when a user has just converted on search, increase their lifetime value (LTV) by cross-selling them complementary products on Facebook. What could be easier?



Measurement

9. Use a standardized naming convention.

File this advice in the “You can’t manage what you don’t measure” folder. If your paid search and social teams implement standardized campaign naming, it’s easy to roll up campaign results across channels. At Marin, we recommend that your campaign name matches the UTM structure in your URLs and app events tracked from your mobile SDK so that everything coordinates with your analytics tool.



10. Align on a unified attribution model.

Many search and social teams still operate on a last-click conversion, which doesn't take into account all of the interactions that took place prior to purchase. Teams should align on an attribution model that accounts for all touchpoints to conversion, across channels with a common conversion window. For example:

- If an advertiser views a conversion report on a last-click attribution that assigns 100% of credit to the final touchpoint (the final click a person converted on), the brand doesn't have visibility into the true path to conversion. Many single-channel platforms that just specialize in search or social face this sobering reality.
- With cross-channel media management platforms like Marin Software, advertisers can better identify which channels drove a conversion and implement attribution models to adjust ad spend more intelligently.
- Using a linear attribution model that gives equal credit to each touchpoint along the path to conversion allows for a better analysis of how each channel influenced top-line revenue.

A large, dark, metallic funnel is centered on a dark blue background. The funnel has a wide, flared top and tapers down to a narrow stem. The text "3. Incremental Lift Testing Across Channels" is written in a light blue, sans-serif font across the middle of the funnel's body.

3. Incremental Lift Testing Across Channels

To assess how well your cross-channel search and social advertising efforts are working, it's essential to run a test to identify the incremental lift in performance of unified campaigns versus campaigns that run in silo.

What's an Incremental Lift Test?

Incremental revenue is additional money that you wouldn't have gained without running a specific campaign. An incremental lift analysis, then, assesses the average revenue from two groups:

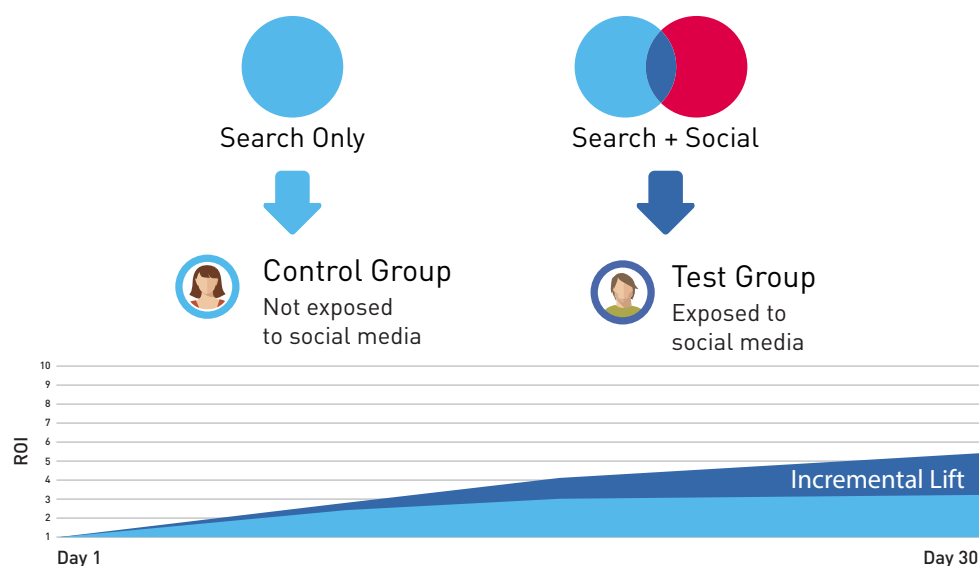
1. People exposed to certain variables within a test group (two segments)
2. People in a control group

The Framework

A popular setup for an incremental analysis involves testing the average revenue of the two segments in our test group:

1. Those who converted from a paid search campaign over a certain period
2. Those who converted from a paid search campaign and were added to a "cross-sell" audience exposed to a dynamic ad on Facebook (encouraging the purchase of a complementary item)

With #2, we want to identify the average revenue impact of the group that was added to the cross-sell segment on Facebook. Then, we want to compare this impact to our control group, i.e., those who weren't exposed to a "cross-sell" dynamic ad on Facebook after making a purchase.



The Test

There are several things advertisers should consider when implementing an incremental lift test. In this example, we're using Google Analytics to capture our test results.

- When deciding how long the campaign should run, consider the average time to purchase for first-time buyers and repeat purchases. The campaign should run, at minimum, for the full purchase cycle to best determine impact.
- Simplify creative and messaging iterations, and make sure they're consistent across both paid search and social channels.
- Deploy both the Facebook Pixel and the Google Pixel using a tag management solution. Early into the campaign flight, view conversion data as directional within each publisher, and compare to conversion events or goals within your analytics tool to ensure there are no noticeable discrepancies.
- Set up revenue goals (completed purchase or pre-order request) for the products being amplified in your ads. Be sure to use a monetary value here with the funnel turned on—if you'd like to track landing page success metrics, such as where people bounce within the checkout page, input URLs for each screen page the user will see.
- Ensure the UTM parameters within ads all follow a standardized naming convention, so that you can run funnel reports to analyze the path to conversion.
- A true measure of sales lift uses an attribution model that reveals the individual and collective contribution of each paid channel on the online (or offline) conversion event.
- Select an attribution model within the analytics tool that your digital marketing team fully understands prior to launching campaigns. For the purpose of this analysis, the goal should be to view performance of each touchpoint along the path to conversion.



4. Mapping Google and Facebook Ad Formats Across the Customer Journey

Both Google and Facebook offer advertisers a wide variety of ad formats to reach users at various stages throughout the customer journey. Certain ad types are best suited to generating top-of-funnel brand awareness, whereas others are clearly designed to move users from the consideration phase into conversion. Once users have converted, both channels offer ad formats to maintain and up-sell existing customers so that advertisers gain mindshare with one of their most valuable audience segments.

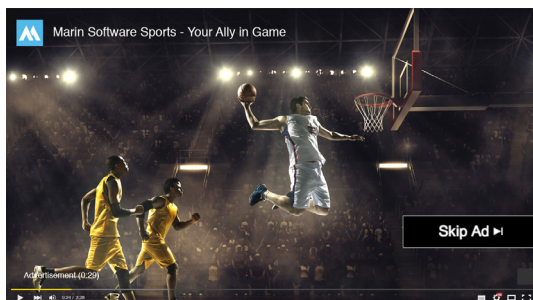
In this section, we compare Google's and Facebook's ad types and objectives, taking a cross-channel perspective to outline the key similarities and differences of each.



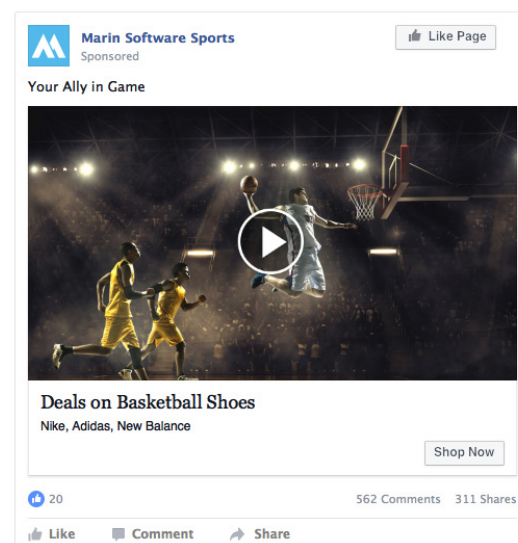
Video for Top-of-Funnel Engagement and Brand Awareness

Advertising budgets are shifting from TV to digital. Here, brand advertisers and agencies are interested in how digital video advertising solutions can align with their commercial messaging. Unlike TV commercials, video ads on Google and Facebook can be instantly measured with video-specific success metrics and audience targeting. Both companies are making considerable advancements to their video ad offering, especially on mobile, where video consumption continues to grow exponentially year over year, with eMarketer predicting 2.15 billion video views in 2017.⁵

YouTube TrueView Video Campaigns



Facebook Video Ads



⁵ eMarketer Releases New Estimates for Video Audience Worldwide, eMarketer, January 13, 2017.

Video Advertising on YouTube

YouTube is Google's primary video advertising vehicle; advertisers can convert their YouTube content into TrueView video ads directly within AdWords. All video content must be hosted on YouTube and can't include text, image, or any other video formats. There are two types of TrueView Ads available within YouTube:

- **In-Stream Ads:** This ad type runs before, during, or after videos on YouTube or video partner sites and apps. As viewers can skip in-stream ads after five seconds, they're more geared towards driving brand awareness rather than concrete conversion goals.
- **Video Discovery Ads:** This ad type runs on YouTube search results, watch pages for both desktop and mobile web, the homepages for desktop and YouTube mobile apps, and the Google Display Network. Video Discovery Ads consist of an image thumbnail and up to three lines of text—clicking the ad delivers a user to the YouTube Watch or Channel page to view the video rather than playing the video within the ad unit itself.

Video Advertising on Facebook

Facebook Video Ads autoplay within a person's Facebook feed, on Instagram, or across the Facebook Audience Network. Videos ads can be standalone, or played mid-stream in a live or non-live video. It's interesting to note that engagement rates tend to be higher on Instagram, which has proven to be a strong video platform. This ad type is designed around the Get Video Views objective. Facebook uses a cost-per-view bidding model with the option to bid and measure results based on the duration of the video that people actually view.

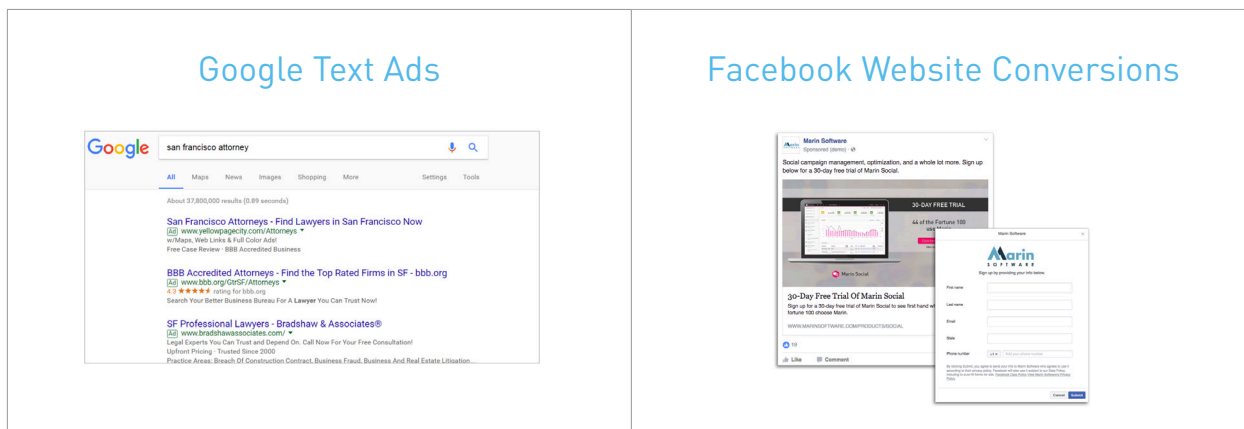
Comparing Video Ads on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
Instagram and YouTube Both Google and Facebook have video-specific metrics that advertisers can view within campaign reports such as the percentage of video watched, cost per video view, and drop-off rates by audience segments. One could also draw similarities between Instagram and YouTube, which allow people to share photo and video easily. YouTube is more geared towards longer form content, whereas Instagram is aimed at mobile and capturing moments on the go, similar to Snapchat. Both acquisitions are focal points for Google's and Facebook's video ad strategies going forward.	Video Views The key difference here is what Facebook and YouTube consider a view. On Facebook, you're charged for any view that lasts longer than three seconds, whereas, on YouTube, a person has to actively choose to interact and watch the video. One would think this entails higher costs on Facebook for fewer quality views, but that's not necessarily the case—Facebook favors advertisers who use video content with their algorithm, as the production costs are traditionally higher to produce high-quality video. So, the lowered costs support still using this format. Another key difference between video on Facebook compared to Google—the feed-based nature of Facebook and Instagram makes this format less intrusive than YouTube's In-Stream Ads. This is because viewers may not even know it's an ad, as the experience doesn't change.



Online Lead Generation Formats for Engagement Stage

A common lead generation tactic for digital marketers is to drive traffic to a web page with a specific call-to-action such as downloading a white paper, signing up for a membership, receiving a quote or even reading a blog post. This practice is especially commonplace with B2B advertisers—across industries such as financial services, software, higher education, and automotive—with specific lead generation budgets and traditionally longer buying cycles. Both Google and Facebook have developed ad formats and conversion metrics specific to driving traffic to your website for lead generation purposes. More advanced formats such as on Facebook lead ads and text ads with phone call extensions on Google have been introduced in recent years to drive improved conversion rates on mobile.



Text Ads on Google

Google Text Ads consist of three parts: headline text, a display URL, and description text. Ad extensions augment text ads with additional information that's immediately useful. For instance, an ad extension can include the phone number of a restaurant you just searched so that you can click-to-call instantly. Extensions are available to advertisers with a high Ad Rank and high ad position, and it's important to be aware that Google dynamically includes an extension if they predict it'll boost an advertiser's performance.

Website Conversion Campaigns on Facebook

Advertisers who implement website conversion campaigns on Facebook are trying to get people to complete a specific action on their website. The Facebook Pixel comes with standard built-in events like lead, sign up, etc. Once this pixel is placed on a website, it begins capturing click behavior and sending that information back to Facebook to feed audiences and reports. Advertisers can select which "event" they want to use to optimize their campaigns within the bidding section of their ads.

Facebook's Lead Ad format reduces the number of clicks it takes for a person to convert, as the signup form is generated within Facebook. With just two clicks, a lead ad form is prepopulated with the person's profile, saving them from jumping out to an external website to fill out a form again. This ad format is intended to help advertisers better scale campaigns on mobile, where landing page conversion rates on mobile websites are historically low. For these reasons, Facebook's Lead Ads can lower an advertiser's cost per conversion rate dramatically.

Comparing Lead Generation Formats on Both Channels

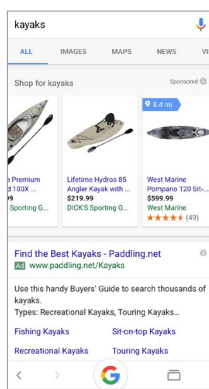
Key Similarities	Key Differences
Conversion Events Website conversion campaigns on Facebook are similar to Google. Both direct a person to a sign-up page and a conversion pixel typically fires on the thank you page, allowing advertisers to identify the overall cost for leads driven from a particular campaign. Bidding Targets Both Google and Facebook offer bidding capabilities that allow advertisers to deliver the maximum amount of conversions at the cost per acquisition (CPA) they're willing to pay. On Google, this is referred to as Target CPA bidding, an AdWords smart bidding strategy. On Facebook, this is referred to as Cost per Result, where advertisers can define a "maximum" or an "average value" they're willing to pay for a conversion.	Capturing Intent - Push Vs. Pull Facebook tries to identify people who would be interested in your product or service based on offline and online behavior. This allows more flexibility for advertisers to reach people at the top of the funnel. By contrast, Google's Text Ads are shown to people based on the intent they illustrate after typing in a search query. Landing Page Form Creation As it stands today, Google does not have an ad format which populates a form without taking a person to a landing page. Lead Ads on Facebook have proven to be very effective for B2B companies who wish to capture buying intent at the engagement stage.



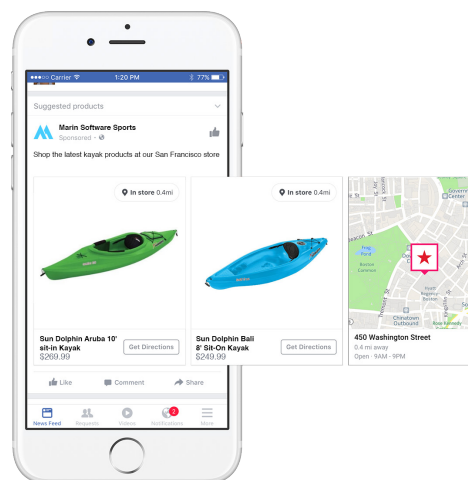
Retail: Optimize Campaigns to In-store Traffic and Sales

In the Digital Age, it may surprise you to learn that 90% of retail sales still occur in-store. Google and Facebook have made significant advancements in the past year or so that allow advertisers to bridge online digital practices with the offline world. These retail-oriented feature sets provide advertisers with the ability to target mobile users based on their location near a store, automatically deliver ads based on inventory performance data, and measure sales impact at the cash register after someone sees or clicks an ad. Omnichannel retailers like Target or Sephora are faced with an ever-growing demand to connect with their guests through digital channels and maintain that same guest-centric messaging in-store. With ads generated from a product feed, omnichannel retailers can now deliver a 1:1 guest experience across devices and channels.

Google Local Inventory Ads



Facebook Dynamic Ads for Retail



Google Local Inventory Ads

Retail advertisers can deliver ads with dynamic copy on mobile devices based on a shopper's proximity to a store, and deliver ads based on a particular store's inventory.

Facebook Dynamic Ads for Retail

Allows retail advertisers to deliver ads on mobile devices based on location and in-store inventory at the SKU level.

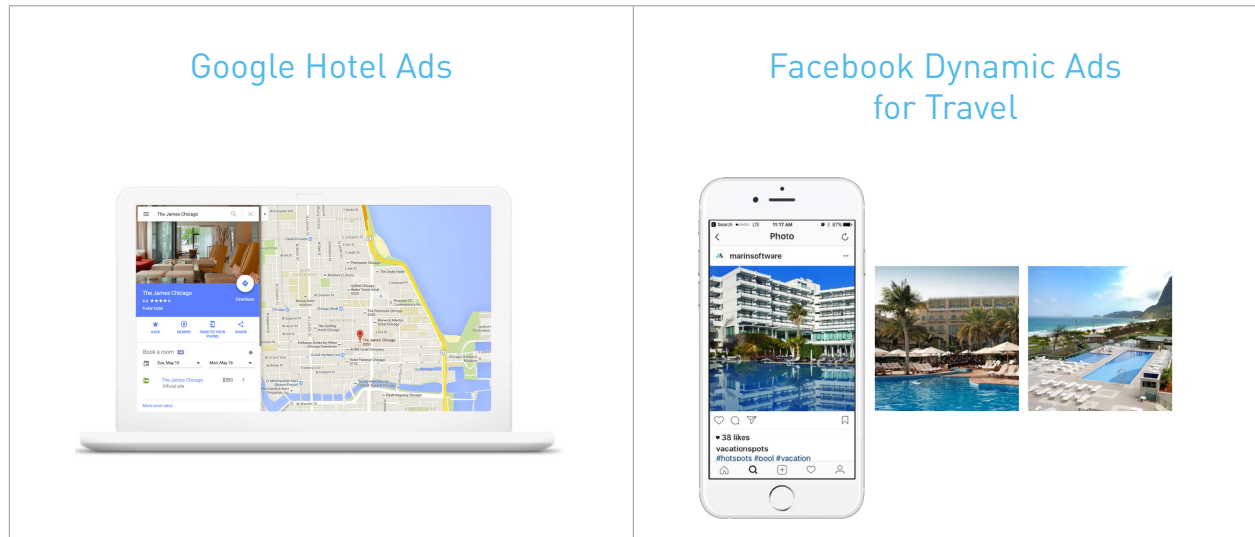
Comparing Retail Formats on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
Driving In-store Trips and Sales The purpose of these ad formats is to engage people while they're within proximity to a specific store on their mobile device with the objective of getting them to go in-store and make a purchase. The delivery of the ad requires a data feed that specifies inventory levels for each store to ensure the product advertised is actually in stock when the person sees the ad. The Store Visit KPI Both Google and Facebook allow retail advertisers to report and optimize campaigns based on actual foot traffic to a store. This KPI is referred to as "Store Visits" on both networks. The ultimate goal is to be able to track spend to the actual Point of Sale (POS) conversion. This allows omnichannel retailers to "close the loop" for measuring the offline impact of online campaigns.	Landing Page Experience With Local Inventory Ads on Google, a person is brought to a Google hosted page for that particular store, where they are shown an ad with directions to the store to make a purchase or the option to buy online from their mobile device. On Facebook, the experience remains within the mobile news feed where advertisers must use the carousel format if they want to highlight which products are available at a nearby store as well as a map card to the store. The person has to swipe to the left to view each creative image.

Feed-Based Ads for Travel Advertisers

Dynamic ads bring game-changing value to travel advertisers. Between short buying cycles, constantly changing pricing and availability, and nonstop searches for a wide variety of locations and destinations, travel advertisers must keep up with unique industry challenges.

With feed-based ad delivery, advertisers can automatically generate creative and deploy ads across all stages of the buyer journey. Travel advertisers can benefit from using customer data to deploy cross-channel strategies across each stage of the journey.



Google Hotel Ads

When someone performs a search using a hotel-related keyword that an advertiser would like to rank for, that advertiser's Hotel Ad will display on the Google Search Network, including Google.com and Google Maps.

You need three types of feeds to implement Hotel Ads: Hotel Listing, Price and Availability, and Point of Sale.

Facebook Dynamic Ads for Travel

Dynamic Ads for Travel (DAT) allows advertisers to automatically deliver ads at a product level from their catalogs with unique creative, based on a person's click events on a website or mobile application.

Facebook developed this ad format specifically for companies in the travel vertical. It supports Destinations, Hotels, and Flights.

Comparing Feed-Based Travel Ads on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
Product / Catalog Feeds Both Dynamic Ads for Travel and Hotel Ads require a feed in order to determine which ad to deliver to a specific destination. Once the ad network ingests the feed, advertisers can create groupings of similar information—e.g., Highest Guest Ratings, Hotels on the East Coast, etc.—to deliver more relevant ads.	Dynamic Ad Triggers Hotel Ads don't require a pixel on a company's website, as the ads get served when someone performs the Google search query. On Facebook, Dynamic Ads for Travel trigger when someone completes a click event such as searching a specific destination within a form on the website. Because the website captures the dynamic audience, advertisers can automatically create upsell and cross-sell segments.

Product Feeds

Product feeds exist in paid and non-paid channels alike. Google, Facebook, and Amazon are all paid channels—non-paid channels include Chegg, sears.com, daily deal, and shopping comparison sites.

Product feeds function as a source of truth on all attributes related to a product, such as price, SKU#, color, and information about availability (e.g., inventory and location). If you've used the Google Merchant Center to list your products within Google Shopping or amplify your catalog with ads across Google's Ad Network, then you're familiar with product feeds.

On Facebook, it works in a very similar way. Here, information from a product feed can determine which ad to deliver to whom. With feed-based ad delivery expected to evolve beyond travel and retail in 2017, it's more important than ever for digital marketers to have a product feed management solution across paid channels.

Google Merchant Center

The Google Merchant Center is where advertisers list details about their products such as sales price, availability, loyalty points, etc., to make their product offering organically available within Google Shopping. To create Shopping campaigns, advertisers must link an AdWords account and the Google Merchant Center with a product feed.

Facebook Product Feeds

On Facebook, a product feed represents product-specific attributes such as a SKU# or hotel. When it's used with Dynamic Ads, this information determines which ad to deliver. Facebook Dynamic Ads are vertical-specific—such as travel and retail—and they support catalogs for brands within the vertical.

The screenshot displays the Google Merchant Center dashboard. On the left is a navigation menu with links: Dashboard, Data feeds, Products (highlighted), Data quality, API Dashboard, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Products' and includes filters for Destination (Shopping), Status (All), and Country (United States). A note states: 'Note: Paid click data is aggregated for the last 30 days. All click data is based on data available in AdWords and is calculated based on the timezone of your AdWords account.' Below this is a table with columns: Title, Price, Availability, Condition, Shopping, Paid Clicks, Country, and Language. One product is listed with the title 'nipon', a price of '\$20.00', and an availability of 'in stock'. The table also includes 'Delete' and 'Lookup by Id' buttons for each product entry.

Title	Price	Availability	Condition	Shopping	Paid Clicks	Country	Language
☐ nipon	\$20.00	in stock	new		0		Abkhazian

Comparing Product Feeds on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
Feeds Fuel Direct Response The information required for a product feed on Facebook is very similar to what's required within Google Merchant Center, and can be ingested automatically in XML format or uploaded as a .CSV file. A product feed is required for dynamic ad delivery. Search advertisers are very familiar with feed-based ad delivery, especially those within the retail and e-commerce verticals. Direct response advertisers turn to feed-based ad delivery, because it's viewed as one of the most effective ad types in driving ROI. This is due to its micro-targeting options. Whether in search or social, advertisers can deliver more personalized creative with images and text that are relevant to a person's intent. Advertisers can save countless hours that would otherwise be required to create unique ads for each SKU and targeting scenario.	Product Attributes vs. Click Events Shopping Ads on Google aren't targeted by keywords. Instead, they use the product attributes defined in an advertiser's product data feed to determine how and where to show an ad when someone uses a relevant query on Google Search. Dynamic Ads on Facebook also require a product feed. However, the audience that sees the ad is defined by a person's click events on a website or app with the Facebook Pixel installed.

Google Display Network (GDN) and the Facebook Audience Network (FAN)

We're used to seeing ads on Google and Facebook, but many people don't realize that both platforms allow you to deliver ads on publisher apps and websites. Essentially, Google and Facebook allow you to use the data from their user base to better target your ads across the web. Publishers can sign up to offer their inventory to advertisers, and in return receive a small fee for clicks and impressions.

Google Display Network

The GDN (also called "AdSense") comprises around two million websites and 650,000 apps, in addition to Google properties like Gmail and YouTube. Publishers can gain access to this network by making their inventory ad-accessible.

Advertisers can place text ads, rich media, image, and video ads on websites and apps within the Google Display Network. You can target people based on the type of keywords used on these websites, or topic groupings such as "travel and leisure" websites. You can also remarket to select audiences and target by demographic information.

Facebook Audience Network

The FAN allows you to deliver ads outside of Facebook and Instagram to people browsing participating mobile applications or websites. Currently, Facebook doesn't publicly state how many publishers have opted into the network. All targeting options, placements, and measurement types on Facebook are available within FAN, making the network very appealing to advertisers.

Comparing Ad Networks on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
Publisher Monetization Offering Both Google and Facebook offer publishers a way to monetize their digital properties by making their ad space and offerings available to advertisers. Both also have metrics for publishers that allow them to understand how certain placements on their website or app are performing in comparison to other publishers. Publishers who improve their scores will, in theory, receive a higher return on clicks, impressions, and results from their placements. On Google, this metric is called "Active View." This provides an overview of how likely it was that a person actually saw the ad, with insights into which placements have higher visibility. On Facebook, this metric is called "Advertiser Outcome Score" or "AOS," a numerical value from 1 to 14 with 14 being the best across your placements.	GDN vs. FAN The key difference here is that FAN is currently limited to native app inventory and mobile web, whereas Google is open to desktop. Publishers must have installed the Facebook SDK and opted in. A key difference between Active View and AOS is that the latter is more geared toward actual conversions than impressions. For example, if an advertiser is bidding on app installs, then the AOS determines ranking based on this desired outcome, not just impressions.



Cross-Sell and Upsell Existing Customers with Audience Targeting

There are a number of different ways to target people with ads on Facebook and Google. One of the more efficient is using customer data, such as purchase history, to influence your segmentation strategy. Both Google and Facebook allow you create audience segments by matching a data file with identifiable information (like an email address) to individual users. You can also capture audience segments when people visit your digital properties and by tracking offline conversion events.

Google Customer Match

With Customer Match, you can upload the email addresses of past customers or email subscribers directly to AdWords. Then, you can leverage this first-party data to target that audience through Google Search, Gmail, or YouTube.

In addition, you can use search intent to build audience segments, and then adjust bids or change the creative message to maximize the chances of captivating viewers. Although this is considered a secondary targeting option, since users must first search for a relevant keyword before being added to an audience, it's still a great way of building brand awareness and increasing conversions.

Facebook Custom Audiences

Facebook coined the term “people-based marketing” for this type of ad delivery. With Custom Audiences, advertisers can use personally identifiable information from a Facebook profile—such as an email or phone number—to create an audience.

On Facebook, there are several ways to deliver an ad to a verified audience:

- **Engagement on Facebook:** Target ads to people who've engaged with any piece of content on Facebook, including a Video Ad, Lead Ad, Canvas Ad, or Page.
- **Website Custom Audience:** Remarket to people who've taken specific actions or visited certain pages of a website.
- **Data File:** Upload a .CSV file that includes information such as email address, name, gender, phone number, etc.
- **App:** With Facebook's software development kit (SDK) installed, remarket to people who've interacted with a mobile application (download, in-app purchase, etc.). If you've developed a web app on Facebook, you can also market to people who've used that app.
- **Dynamic Audiences:** Advertisers can implement the Facebook Pixel on a website or app, and then use it to build dynamic audiences for travel and retail. Once these audiences are built, you can use Dynamic Ads to automatically launch ad creatives with information from a feed, based on where a person is in the funnel and the intent they've shown on a website. From a cross-channel perspective, the main benefit is that direct response advertisers can combine search and social for incremental lift. For example, suppose someone clicks a paid search ad to book a hotel room and converts. With a solution like Marin's Dynamic Ads for Travel, you could upsell everyone who's taken that action, by offering a spa visit that only runs the week prior to and during the user's vacation.

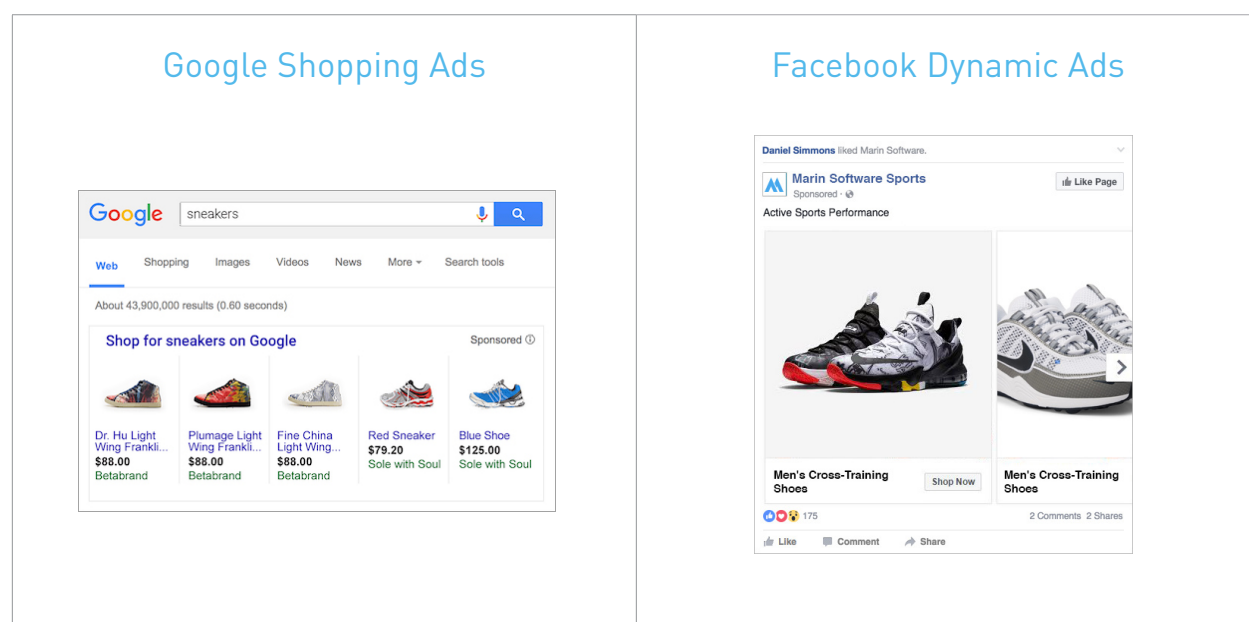
Comparing Cross-Sell and Upsell Opportunities on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
Customer Data The information needed to create a custom audience or customer match generally resides within a company's CRM system. You can connect information about a customer's offline and online behavior to groups of anonymous individuals to create a Facebook Custom Audience or a Google Customer Match.	Customer Match vs. Custom Audiences Customer Match isn't currently available on GDN. However, custom audience marketing is available within the FAN. Facebook allows advertisers to be more granular with customer files that can be matched based on additional attributes such as phone numbers, names, dates of birth, gender, locations, app user IDs, page scoped user IDs, Apple's Advertising Identifier (IDFA), or their Android Advertising ID. Another key difference between the two formats is that Google offers less flexibility around remarketing to people based on their activities. Currently, you can only build remarketing segments based on interactions with YouTube videos. On Facebook, you can create remarketing segments based on interactions with a page, Lead Ad, Canvas Ad, or Video Ad across all platforms including Facebook, Instagram, and FAN.



E-Commerce: Grow Online Sales with Automated Ad Delivery from your Product Feed

The future of online advertising for direct response marketers is being driven by innovations related to automatic ad creation from a product feed. Google was the first to support dynamic ad creation with a solution called “Google Shopping”, which uses the Google Merchant Center as the source of the product feed. The equivalent offering for e-commerce advertisers on Facebook is called Dynamic Ads. For direct response initiatives, this is the top-performing ad unit on both Google and Facebook, respectively.



Google Product Listing Ads

Product Listing ads are dynamic feed-based ads that match a user's search query with products in a feed. They appear in the Shopping section of Google Search next to search results, and in YouTube or Image Search.

Product Listing Ads allow retail/e-commerce advertisers the ability to configure how product-level data from their merchant center is used within their AdWords campaigns. This includes information like promotion ID, custom label, and destination URLs.

Facebook Dynamic Ads

Facebook also offers an automated, feed-based approach that allows e-commerce advertisers to deliver ads based on click events people make within a mobile app or on a website. Dynamic Ads on Facebook can appear within the News Feed on mobile or desktop, the right-hand rail, and outside of Facebook within the Audience Network or on Instagram.

With dynamic ads, you can target customers with high shopping intent for your products. Dynamic ads offer scaled creative and automated delivery to reach customers most likely to purchase with retargeting or to expand to broad audiences. Additionally, you can deliver dynamic ads to customers with upsell and cross-sell campaigns.

Comparing Automated Ad Delivery on Both Channels

Key Similarities	Key Differences
E-commerce + Retail Shopping campaigns on Google and Dynamic Ad campaigns on Facebook both rely on a product feed to automatically generate creative. The Key Performance Indicators for these ad formats are direct response orientated with the goal of driving online sales. You can create more relevant ads by grouping similar products together from your feed with the use of Product Groups on Google and Product Sets on Facebook. E-commerce advertisers can create groupings by attributes like category, product type, brand, and condition. These groupings provide more control over who sees your feed-based ads with the ability to set bids across each accordingly. For example, you could create a grouping of the best margin products for upsell efforts.	Queries vs. Audiences Google Shopping Ads are shown if someone performs a search query related to a particular product. However, on Facebook, inventory isn't limited by search volume—advertisers can bid on audiences across each spectrum of the conversion funnel.

Measurement Tools From Facebook and Google

Both Google and Facebook provide robust analytics solutions that allow advertisers to better understand campaign performance. Simply put, you're flying blind if you're not using the following analytics capabilities for your campaigns.

Google

- **AdWords Reports:** With AdWords, advertisers can view performance metrics such as impressions, clicks, and conversions.
- **Google Analytics:** This free enterprise analytics solution allows you to track and measure KPIs to conversion events. You can set up conversion goals to understand how traffic from your ad spend is performing compared to other channels such as email, organic, display, and social. Google has robust tracking capabilities for companies using Google Voice numbers with ads that have a phone number. When someone clicks these ads and converts, advertisers can view in-depth reports on metrics like length of call. Both Google and Facebook also provide robust analytics solutions for mobile apps, which require an SDK to be embedded in an app.
- **Google Tag Manager:** This is a free enterprise tag management solution that allows advertisers to manage rule configuration and pixel deployment, all from one place. Facebook doesn't provide a tag management solution currently.
- **Remarketing Tag:** Advertisers can create remarketing lists with either the Remarketing Tag or Google Analytics Tag installed on a website. To be able to track click events that occur on a website after someone clicks an ad, you simply embed the Conversion Tracking Tag on all pages of your website.

Facebook

- **Facebook Ad Reports:** Advertisers can view a variety of reports based on campaign objectives and ad formats. You can view conversion data on a post-impression or post-click conversion window with 1/7/28 day look-backs. There is one significant difference between Facebook and Google reports, however—Facebook lets you gauge how people feel about a particular topic with interaction data such as likes, comments, and shares.
- **Audience Insights:** This tool allows you to gain insights from your custom audiences. You can view breakdowns by demographic, page likes, location, activity, household, and purchase behavior, based on information people provide in their profiles and data that Facebook harvests through third-party providers such as Acxiom, Datalogix, and Epsilon.
- **Facebook Pixel:** This is a single pixel that, when embedded on a website, allows you to create retargeting audience segments and track conversions. Once it's installed, the Facebook Pixel can be setup to record standard events such as view content, add to cart, lead, and so on. You can also add custom events to track specific conversions to a page URL.

Closing the Loop to Offline Metrics

Both Google and Facebook now offer advertisers a way to measure how well their campaigns are driving offline actions such as phone calls, trips to the store, and event attendance. In 2016, Facebook launched the Offline Conversion API which functions in a very similar way to Google's Offline Conversion Tracking:

- Advertiser configures their ad accounts for offline conversion tracking
- Offline conversion event data is sent to Facebook and Google via API or CSV upload
- Facebook and Google matches the offline conversion events that you're tracking to people who were targeted with your ads
- You can then view these offline conversion metrics tied to your campaigns within your Google and Facebook reports

Offline conversion tracking allows you to close the loop beyond clicks and impressions to capture actual revenue metrics from offline activities.

Google	Facebook
Offline Conversion Tracking With Offline Conversion Tracking, advertisers can match a unique ID# referred to as "GCLID" back to any conversions that occurred as a result of someone clicking an ad. If someone converts offline, that unique ID# is matched to available information about the person and tracked accordingly. Google also has a more robust attribution tool called "Attribution 360," which is geared towards advertisers interested in associating Point of Sale (POS) data with the user's path to conversion. Store Visits and Store Transactions reports are available to advertisers who want to attribute offline sales that are driven by Google Search and Display Ads.	Offline Conversions With Facebook's Offline Conversions feature, advertisers can measure the impact of their ads to actual sales that occur offline. This information traditionally lives in POS systems for retailers and CRM systems for e-commerce or B2B companies. Facebook advertisers can now track, measure, optimize, and report on these offline conversion events by categorizing sets of offline event transaction data, and by aligning this data with online events tracked using the Facebook Pixel. With offline conversions you can currently track the following conversion events: • ViewContent • Search • AddToCart • AddToWishList • InitiateCheckout • AddPaymentInfo • Lead • CompleteRegistration • Other Advertisers can also create "custom events" based on a business case. For example, as a result of new and existing customers seeing or clicking Facebook ads, a B2B company could create custom events called Opportunities, Closed Opportunities, and Revenue from sales team activity.

A large, dark, metallic funnel is centered on a dark blue background. The funnel has a wide, flared top and tapers down to a narrow stem. The text "5. Parting Thoughts" is written in a light blue, sans-serif font across the middle of the funnel's body.

5. Parting Thoughts

With our experience managing billions in annual ad spend for thousands of advertisers, Marin can see that a siloed, single-channel approach leaves dollars on the table. In the game of digital advertising, sophisticated organizations that cultivate a cross-channel culture will emerge as clear winners. A unified approach to planning, executing, and measuring search and social campaigns together will maximize the total impact of each channel. Still, organizations invested in a cross-channel approach must overcome several barriers to success.

Addressing the Main Challenges of a Unified Program

We've found that the biggest obstacles to coordinating advertising programs across channels include:

1. Organizational structure that separates search and social activities
2. Lack of experience setting up and executing a cross-channel campaign
3. Measuring performance beyond last click to encompass the full customer journey

Organizational structure

The best way to overcome organizational barriers to unified campaigns is to demonstrate results. Using incremental lift pilots, it's possible to allocate budget to prove revenue growth of unifying channels versus operating them in silo.

Enacting a killer cross-channel campaign

Use the plays in this document to drive incremental lift and measure success. We suggest starting with a modest budget and delivering quick wins, so that you can clearly see the value of bringing your search and social teams closer together. Note that you can execute many of these plays without the need for changes to your ad tech stack.

Measuring performance beyond last-click

Audience hashing has evolved on both Google and Facebook as a means to not only reach the right people more efficiently, but also to measure performance to actual revenue both online and offline. We recommend that you implement an attribution model to better understand each touchpoint to conversion, to measure success more accurately, and to allocate your budget properly.

Partnering for Success

Marin Software delivers the leading independent multichannel digital advertising platform. As pioneers, we grew by helping our customers make sense of—and thrive in—the online advertising frontier. As an ally, we're still standing with marketers, helping them win more customers, and increase revenue and ROI.

How? Our open platform unites search and social. With Marin, advertisers extend insights and actions across channels and take a multichannel approach to reaching target audiences with the right message at the right time. Internal and external data come together to connect advertisers to customers—we can handle more data from more sources better than anyone else.

Our multichannel approach has paid off with tremendous dividends for our clients. For example:

- **PhotoBox** adopted Marin's Smart Sync for Dynamic Ads to automatically clone their product groups from Google Shopping campaigns into product sets on Facebook, resulting in a 2x increase in ROI.
- **Meliá**, one of the largest hotel companies in the world, is using data on Google search queries to power Custom Audiences on Facebook with Marin's search intent. Meliá has seen a 36% decrease in CPA with Marin's search intent audiences. And, its seen a 6.7x increase in ROI by unifying search and social to reach high value audiences across channels, based on where those audiences are in the buyer's journey.

The world's top brands rely on Marin Software to help them reach their customers. When the C-suite wants a 360-degree view of the current and future digital landscape, we're there leading the conversation—and backing up our vision with a platform that works. Customers come to us for measurable performance, reliability, and scalability. Our technology is ready for the largest, most demanding customers. Transparency plus the right experience and partnerships add muscle to our solution. The upside is clear: Marketers see better results from their digital spend as they save time with Marin Software. That's our promise to customers, and our whole team is accountable for making it happen. Every day.

For more information on Marin's multichannel expertise, please contact our team of advertising experts.



Your Ally in Digital

Request a Demo: www.marinsoftware.com/learnmore

The Authors



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Brett has managed over \$50 million in ad spend on Google and Facebook for a variety of companies ranging from startup to Fortune 500. Brett led paid social for Target Corp, and acquisition efforts for Cartwheel, Target's first digital product team and internal startup. The Cartwheel app achieved, and has sustained, a top 5 ranking in the retail category on both the Apple and Google Play stores, with over 10 million downloads in its first year. Prior to joining Marin, Brett co-founded a Minneapolis based digital marketing agency called Opnia that specialized in Facebook advertising. While at Opnia, Brett launched an in-store to online remarketing platform utilizing beacon technology to help Retailers better understand the offline customer journey. Brett has a B.S. in Marketing from St. Johns University and is a die-hard Minnesota Vikings fan.



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Wesley MacLaggan

Wesley MacLaggan has been working with Marin Software since 2008. He is currently Senior Vice President of Marketing at Marin Software. Previously he lead the Product team where he was responsible for driving Marin's roadmap and working closely with engineering to deliver innovative advertising solutions to the market. He has over a decade's experience developing and delivering analytical enterprise SaaS applications, including four years with Applied Predictive Technologies working on their platform to help retailers maximize the return on their promotional spending. Mr. MacLaggan began his career providing strategic guidance to companies in a range of industries with Mercer Management Consulting. He holds an Economics degree from Dartmouth College.